

don't think the way things are done right now are precedent-setting," he said.²⁹ In the end, Buterin and much of the Ethereum team used their own technical skills to aggressively correct the situation that The DAO had created.³⁰

A hard fork doesn't come without risks, and unfortunately, Ethereum would pay a dear price for its decision to help The DAO. While hard forks are often used to upgrade a blockchain architecture, they are typically employed in situations where the community agrees entirely on the beneficial updates to the architecture. Ethereum's situation was different, as many in the community opposed a hard fork. Contentious hard forks are dangerous, because when new software updates are released for a blockchain in the form of a hard fork, there are then two different operating systems. While the two operating systems share a common ancestor, and therein a common record of transactions, once the hard fork occurs, the two operating systems split, and so too do their blockchains, each with separate native units. While some people think, "Great, I've just doubled my money," a hard fork can often crash the value of the native units on the two separate blockchains, as people worry about an ongoing schism within a divided community (see [Figure 5.2](#)). With two separate blockchains, miners, developers, and companies building applications, users must decide which blockchain and its inherent operating system to support. While many initially claimed the hard fork a success for Ethereum, a few big traders started to buy up as much of the native asset on the lesser supported chain as possible.